



A 1000-year-old Viking toilet

In a Viking settlement on Stevns in Denmark, archaeologists excavated a two metre deep hole containing 1000-year-old –wait for it – human faeces.

“It was a totally random find. We were looking for pit houses – semi-subterranean workshop huts – and it really looked like that from the surface. But we soon realised that it was something totally different,” says PhD student Anna Beck from the Museum Southeast Denmark. Although toilets were pretty common in Viking towns, in the countryside, people typically took their business in barns or bushes in the forest. All the manure was valuable as fertilizers, regardless of whether it came from animals or humans. And so many archaeologists argue on the discovery saying that toilets were unheard-of in the rural sectors until the 18th century. However, Anna Beck thinks this might have been a part of a larger cultural shift. “We know about privy buildings inside cities in the latter part of the Viking Age and the early Middle Ages, but not from agrarian settlements and farms. We imagined that people had defecated in the midden or in the barn with the animals in order to use their waste as fertiliser for the fields,” she says.

<http://dgit.in/VikingT>

Move aside RC Aircraft, RC Pigeons are the next best thing

Controlling something is one of life's simpler pleasures. That's why people enjoy driving, for instance. And for those who find that too stressful, everyone still likes remote controlled cars and aircraft. If you want to take it up a notch, scientists may soon be on the verge of creating RC Pigeons!

Scientists at Robot Engineering Technology Research Centre at Shandong University of Science and Technology in China, have succeeded in planting implants in a pigeon's brain. When signals are passed to these implants, it stimulates different parts of the brain, letting you control its motion. They are able to make it fly left, right, up and down. And it's not just limited to pigeons either. Scientists on working on implanting electrodes in fish, rats and mice because it has tremendous potential. For instance, if this kind of research is successful, such remote controlled rats can be taken to landslide hit areas to look for people trapped under the rubble. Mind control is real folks – just not in the way we usually imagine it to be. <http://dgit.in/RCpigeons>



A table-sized NES controller



A company called Retro-Bit is trying to sell you a coffee table with super-sized

buttons that you can actually use to play classic Nintendo NES games. First announced in E3, the 'Mega Table' will go on sale on kickstarter for \$500. <http://dgit.in/NEStable>

Porn could soon get boring



Giant porn sites like Pornhub, Redtube, xHamster and many more voice their

concerns explaining why the end of net neutrality could make the adult industry and watching pornography become very vanilla and boring. <http://dgit.in/sexnet>

Sumo wrestling robots



This robot-version of Japan's national sport is not only super fast and brutal, but also a

lot of fun to watch. The autonomous robots act entirely based on certain pre-programmed behaviours and are open to any number of tactics to knock their opponent out of the ring. <http://dgit.in/Botsumo>